ERIC RINCON

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EXPERIENCE

Expedia Group — Austin, TX

Machine Learning Scientist III

November 2020 – Present

- Applying machine learning to various recommendation problems that scale to millions of users
- Researching application of LLMs to problems in recommendation systems
- Fine tuning LLMs for natural language search applications
- Building internal tools for use across the ML recommendations team

Under Armour — Austin, TX

Data Scientist

January 2020 – November 2020

- Working with stakeholders to identify opportunities for leveraging company data to make better decisions and understand consumer behavior.
- Building algorithms to measure and optimize customer experiences, revenue generation, ad targeting and other business outcomes

CognitiveScale — Austin, TX

Applied Machine Learning Scientist

September 2018 – January 2020

- Collaborated with businesses stakeholders to identify and frame machine learning problems.
- Applied a variety of machine learning model classes such as survival analysis, NLP, computer vision, and representation learning.
- Developed production ready models for internal company use and worked with software engineers for deployment

UT Austin - Psychoinformatics Lab — Austin, TX

Social Science/Humanities Research Associate I

August 2018 – September 2018

- Worked on applying representation learning techniques to psychometric data. The main goal was to learn a global representation for personality by training a variational autoencoder on a variety of personality inventories.

Good Citizen Network Foundation — Austin, TX

Software Engineer

March 2018 – May 2018

- Built REST APIs and backend utilizing JavaScript, Express, MongoDB; worked on front end Vue.js code.

Guild Consulting — Austin, TX

Data Scientist & Software Engineer

September 2017 – February 2018

- Built REST APIs and data models for client projects using Python, Flask, JavaScript and Express

Apple — Austin, TX

Data Scientist - NLP Intern

May 2016 – September 2017

- Applied machine learning techniques to classify, cluster, and understand unstructured customer issue notes.
- Designed dashboards to disseminate findings from machine learning models to nontechnical users.
- Worked with internal team of software engineers on deploying models to a production environment.

EDUCATION

University of Texas at Austin

Austin, TX

B.S. in Computer Science

B.S. in Mathematics

Graduated August 2018

SELECT PROJECTS

Assisting Customer Support Analysts with NLP

- *Question*—Can we automate the categorization of customer issue descriptions into an internal issue taxonomy?
- *Approach*—Trained a convolutional neural network to classify customer issue descriptions.
- *Solution*—Implemented in Python using TensorFlow and exposed to end-users via a GUI running as a Flask application. Collaborated with software engineers to put into prediction to serve to domain experts through a UI.

Predicting Multiple Events from EMR Data

- *Question*—Can we assist medical practitioners by predicting whether events of interest will occur to patients in the future utilizing EMR data and unstructured progress notes all while providing explanations?
- *Approach*—Combined survival analysis techniques and black box explainability models i.e., shapley values.
- *Solution*—Used Tensorflow to create a neural network that parameterizes a weibull distribution for each event of interest and takes as input two modalities, progress notes and EMR data.

Ongoing Projects...

Prediction Market Modeling & Trading

Building quant trading algorithms for live in-game prediction markets on Kalshi. Researching Neural Hawkes Processes for modeling real-time odds dynamics and LLMs as calibrated probabilistic forecasters.

Multimodal Edge Biometric Security System

Building a multi-modal person ID system on Jetson Orin combining face recognition and gait analysis via score fusion, improving edge reliability over single-modality approaches that degrade with distance, occlusion, or single-camera noise.

PROGRAMMING

Python, R, TensorFlow, PyTorch
PyData stack, PySpark
Swift, Java, JavaScript, MongoDB, SQL
Flask, Mongoose, Express
C, MATLAB, VueJS
C++
Rust

